

From: Oliver Grundmann
Sent time: 01/27/2024 02:52:40 PM
To: JW Ross <jross@leafkratomcoalition.org>; Mac Haddow <mhaddow1@verizon.net>; Brandon McLaren <brandon@dbzenterprises.com>; Ryan Burroughs <ryan@americankratom.org>; David <david@botanaway.com>; Jessica Gerding <sales@titanaries.com>
Cc: Bob Durkin <robert.durkin@agg.com>; Michael McGuffin <mmcguffin@ahpa.org>; Matthew Lowe <mlowe@thekratomcoalition.org>; Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>; McCurdy, Christopher R; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; Soren Shade <soren@toptreeherbs.com>; Alex Wolf <alex@drinknewbrew.com>; Justin Wolf <justin@drinknewbrew.com>; Kelly Dunn <kelly@nvwsd.com>
Subject: RE: AKA V7 of Kratom Bill for CA

Dear all,

from a scientific perspective it does make sense to separate the native kratom leaf material from extracts and concentrates and utilize the existing regulatory framework to position leaf kratom products within it. If this will ultimately lead to federal agencies recognizing leaf kratom as an ODI or food is something that has to be seen.

After many discussions we (primarily Kirsten, Chris, Soren, and a few other researchers) had, I do feel that extracts and concentrates do have a place and should be available to consumers. But they are also distinct in many regards from native kratom leaf material regarding composition and removal of other components that may not themselves have pharmacological activity but potentially play a role in facilitating absorption, metabolism, etc. of the active principles (which we currently consider to be the kratom alkaloids). As Chris likes to point out, the contribution of each alkaloid (and potentially other, yet unknown compounds) is like a symphony and each plays a different role. As we know this to be the case with all natural products that are complex mixtures, it does make sense to separate the leaf from extracts/concentrates.

Best.

Oliver

From: JW Ross <jross@leafkratomcoalition.org>
Sent: Saturday, January 27, 2024 11:20 AM
To: Mac Haddow <mhaddow1@verizon.net>; Brandon McLaren <brandon@dbzenterprises.com>; Ryan Burroughs <ryan@americankratom.org>; David <david@botanaway.com>; Jessica Gerding <sales@titanaries.com>
Cc: Bob Durkin <robert.durkin@agg.com>; Michael McGuffin <mmcguffin@ahpa.org>; Matthew Lowe <mlowe@thekratomcoalition.org>; Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>; McCurdy, Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; Soren Shade <soren@toptreeherbs.com>; Alex Wolf <alex@drinknewbrew.com>; Justin Wolf <justin@drinknewbrew.com>; Kelly Dunn <kelly@nvwsd.com>
Subject: AKA V7 of Kratom Bill for CA

[External Email]

Good morning

Appreciate you guys taking another stab at this (V7 attached), but at this time since your proposed language is based on self regulation vs government regulation we cant support it.

As you are aware the current self regulation is not working and stronger and stronger products are being sold to consumers. It's just a matter of time till enough people get hurt by these products and all kratom gets banned.

If we act quickly we can stop this but it will require government regulation not self regulation.

It's clear based on this draft and the meeting yesterday that you are not ready at this time to set dosage limits and GMP requirements so that we can stop this madness.

We by no means want to hurt your businesses in any way so we will remove all references to the extracts in our CA bill and just focus on passing meaningful government regulation for Leaf Kratom only.

Please understand by doing this it will not make extracts illegal, and we will not ask that extracts be banned or that we feel they are bad.

All we will say is that Leaf Kratom and kratom extracts are different just like CBD vs other forms of cannabis are different and have different regulation.

As we have done to date we also will continue to support the AKA and help as much as we can on passing regulation for the other forms of kratom.

We will continue be open to and would appreciate your input on any Leaf Kratom regulation we are working on.